



Android & XP

The Acer Aspire One AOD250 is the first netbook to dual-boot between Google Android and Windows XP OS



Storm part deux

The BlackBerry Storm 2 previews hit the internet and it seems to provide faster and smoother typing than its predecessor

Bazaar

Philips GoGear Raga and Vibe Media Players

A swarm of portable music players

The square-shaped GoGear Raga has a metal-clad red body that makes it feel tough and look cool. The front bears a small three-line monochrome display. The navigation buttons are a bit stiff. The simple-design UI works swiftly. FM reception is average. Its voice recording feature couldn't capture voices very clearly. Sound quality is just about average but the earphones are a bottleneck. It sounds somewhat flat and will not tingle your audiophile senses. However, swapping to a better pair of earphones will do the trick.

The Philips GoGear Vibe is a slightly advanced cousin of the Raga. It looks quite decent; it's built decently too. The Vibe has a 1.5-inch display that's easy to read; but definitely not that good to use the video playback feature religiously. The buttons on the

Vibe are quite tactile, especially the navigation ones. The sound quality on the Vibe is, fortunately better than the Raga; and unlike it, the output delivered by the default pair of earphones is quite decent. Voice recording and FM like the Raga is pretty average.

The Philips GoGear Raga 2GB is available for Rs. 2,499 and the Vibe 2GB sells for Rs. 3,499. Off the two, we'd recommend the GoGear Vibe if you're looking for a pocketable MP3 player with decent sound.

Contact

Contact: Philips Electronics India Ltd.

Phone: 1860-1801111

E-mail: customercare.India@philips.com

Web site: www.india.philips.com

Price: Rs. 2499 (Raga), Rs. 3499 (Vibe)



Specifications

GoGear Raga

Screen: 128 x 48 pixel, 3 line LCD

Audio Format: MP3, WAV, WMA

Built-in memory: 2GB

Other features: FM Radio, Voice Recorder, FM recording

Playtime on internal battery: Up to 27 hours

RATINGS

Features.....	6
Performance.....	5.5
Build Quality	7
Value for Money	6.5
Overall	6



Specifications

Vibe Media Player

Screen: 128 x 128 pixel, 1.5-inch LCD

Audio Format: MP3, WMA

Built-in memory: 2GB

Other features: FM Radio, Voice Recorder, FM recording

Playtime on internal battery: Up to 25 hours audio or 4 hours video

RATINGS

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	7
Build Quality	6
Value for Money	6.5
Overall	7

Contact

Contact: Nikon India Private Ltd

Phone: +91-124-468 8500

Web site: www.nikon.co.in

Price: Rs. 39,990

Specifications

10.2-MP CCD sensor (23.6 x 15.8 mm), 18-55 mm VR lens

Shutter speed range: 1/4000 - 30 seconds

ISO range: 100 - 3200, 1080

MAH Li-ion Nikon battery

Dimensions: 126 x 97 x 64 mm

Weight: 485 g

RATINGS

Features.....	7
Performance.....	7.5
Build Quality	7.5
Value for money	7
Overall	7

Within reach of many

Intended as a replacement for the D60, Nikon's new D3000 comes with the same standard 18-55 mm VR, 3x optical zoom lens found on other entry-level models. There's no lens motor in the body – typical for its price range. The sensor is the same 10-MP CCD unit in the D60.

The body is a bit bulkier than the D60 with a larger 3-inch screen. Live view is still missing. In contrast, Canon has this feature on their cheaper EOS 1000D. The move to an 11 focus point system up from the 3-point system is good – a welcome feature. Image quality is good with the default lens, although it's a bit inadequate for various shooting conditions.

The high ISO performance is rather good and ISO800 is passable; although it's definitely not in the D90s league.

Nikon's Guide mode simplifies things for newbies with a colourful main menu for the basic operations. The controls are simple to use and unlike the costlier DSLRs, there is no dedicated ISO button and the D3000 makes do with a single jog dial. So, you're forced to use a few more buttons while shooting – good for newbies but not hardcore DSLR users.

The D3000 is a good camera – the body has the right build, the controls are pretty simple



and it gives very good results. It has a great aperture range and shutter speed. At Rs. 37,950, it's a worthy replacement for the entry-level winner of our dSLR test – the D60. For those who already have a D60 or any other cheap dSLR in this range, this isn't for you. You're better off with a Sony A330, a D5000 or even the D90 if those fall within your budget.